

Mohammad Y. Abdelshafy

Rochester, New York, United States

yasser.abdelshafy@rochester.edu | [Energy Research Digest](#)

Education

University of Rochester , Rochester, NY	
<i>Doctor of Philosophy (PhD), Mechanical Engineering</i>	2027 (expected)
<i>Master of Science (MS), Mechanical Engineering</i>	2023
Helwan University , Cairo, Egypt	
<i>Bachelor of Science (BS), Mechanical & Energy Engineering</i>	2022
STEM High School for Boys - 6th of October , Egypt	
<i>High School Diploma, STEM</i>	2017

Research Interests

Fluid dynamics, Rayleigh-Benard convection, liquid metal flows, magnetohydrodynamics (MHD), geophysical fluid dynamics, planetary dynamos.

Research Experience

Doctoral Researcher , University of Rochester, Rochester, NY	Aug 2022 – Present
• Currently exploring the role of rotating convection in the Early Earth's dynamo and its magnetic field. • Designing and building a rotating experiment to explore the effect of boundary roughness on convective heat transfer and flow stability in a rotating Rayleigh-Bénard convection system in both water and liquid gallium. • Invested fluid dynamics in liquid metal batteries to improve operational safety and stability. • Analyzed ultrasound data from liquid metal experiments featuring both current-driven electrovortex flow and convection.	

Teaching Experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant (GTA) Coach , University of Rochester	Jun 2024 – Sep 2024
• Developed and delivered a teaching workshop for new GTAs in mechanical engineering. • Attended a "train-the-trainer" course to prepare session materials aligned with departmental GTA duties.	
Graduate Teaching Assistant , University of Rochester	Jan 2023 – May 2024
• ME241: Fluids Lab (Spring 2023, Spring 2024): Guided students in aerodynamic tests, wind tunnel operation, and analysis of lift and drag. Followed up weekly with student projects. • ME120: Statics (Fall 2022): Delivered revision sessions, held office hours and tutoring sessions, graded assignments, quizzes, and exams, and created exam review material for first-year students. • ENE336: Power Stations Technology: Graded homework and assisted students with problem sets.	

Industry Experience

Engineering Intern, Siemens Energy, New Cairo, Egypt

Aug 2021 – Sep 2021

- Completed intensive training sessions in high voltage power transmission, supplemented by site visits.
- Worked on the design of a step-down substation for an industrial complex in northern Egypt.

Manufacturing Engineer, NATPACK for plastic packaging solutions, El Obour, Egypt

Jan 2021 – Jan 2021

- Supervised the setup and troubleshooting of new tube shouldering machines.

Maintenance Engineer (Intern), NATPACK, El Obour, Egypt

Aug 2020 – Oct 2020

- Gained experience in plastic packaging production, mold design, and machinery maintenance.
- Operated ENGEL injection molding machines and troubleshooted operational halts.
- Supervised 26 maintenance operations in hydraulic and pneumatic systems.
- Managed factory utilities including HVAC, water cooling, and air compression systems.
- Implemented quality and safety measures in production and maintenance.
- Developed a production plan for a tube factory facing labor deficits, aiming to surpass production targets.

Energy Engineering Intern, Agiba Petroleum Co., Matruh, Egypt

Jul 2019 – Jul 2019

- Gained hands-on experience with the operation and monitoring of 2MW gas turbines.
- Focused on turbine and pumping station maintenance.
- Toured drilling sites and natural gas treatment plants.

Publications and Presentations

Journal Publications

- M. Y. Abdelshafy, B. Wang, I. Mohammad, J. S. Cheng, D. H. Kelley. Current-driven flow transitions in laboratory liquid metal battery models. *J. Fluid Mech.* (2025), vol. 1007, A42. [doi:10.1017/jfm.2025.78](https://doi.org/10.1017/jfm.2025.78)

Conference Presentations

- M. Y. Abdelshafy, J. S. Cheng, D. H. Kelley. Laboratory investigation of Topographical effects on outer core flow: Water Experiments. *AGU Fall Meeting*, 2024.
- J. S. Cheng, M. Y. Abdelshafy, D. H. Kelley. Laboratory investigation of topographical effects on outer core flow-liquid metal experiments. *AGU Fall Meeting*, 2024.
- M. Y. Abdelshafy, B. Wang, I. Mohammad, J. S. Cheng, D. H. Kelley. Transition in flows driven by converging currents. *APS Division of Fluid Dynamics Meeting*, 2024.
- J. S. Cheng, M. Y. Abdelshafy, B. Wang, I. Mohammad, D. H. Kelley. Interaction of convective modes with current-driven flow in a liquid metal battery experiment. *APS Division of Fluid Dynamics Meeting*, 2024.
- M. Y. Abdelshafy, J. S. Cheng, I. Mohammad, B. Wang, D. H. Kelley. Electrovortex flow in liquid gallium. *APS Division of Fluid Dynamics Meeting*, 2023.

Skills

Fluid Dynamics:	Experimental design, flow visualization, ultrasound diagnostics, rotating flows
Software:	MATLAB, Python, AutoCAD, Siemens NX, LaTeX
Fabrication:	Manual machining, molding and casting, experimental setup design and construction
Languages:	Arabic (Native), English (Fluent)

Leadership, Service, and Outreach

Board Member , M K Gandhi Institute, Rochester, NY	Ongoing
• Serve on the board of directors for the M K Gandhi Institute for Nonviolence. • Contribute to the development committee, focusing on connecting the institute with organizations involved in nonviolence, healing, and community engagement across the US.	
President , International Students & Scholars Association (ISSA), University of Rochester	May 2024 – Present
• Advocate for international students, and acting as a link between the students and the administration. • Addressing student needs, facilitating smoother academic and personal transitions to the U.S., supporting with tax filing, etc.	
Co-Founder , Larus Textile, Cairo, Egypt	Jul 2019 – Nov 2019
• Co-founded an environmentally aware textile manufacturer. • Participated in the SEYP19 incubation program by You ThinkGreen Egypt. • Conducted market research, developed business plans, and analyzed financial statements. • Successfully pitched the startup idea, securing a 4 million EGP fund.	
Contributing Writer , Altanweeri Online Magazine, Amman, Jordan	Apr 2018 – Sep 2018

Awards and Honors

Finalist, Climate Science Olympiad	2020
Venture Fund (4M EGP), SEYP Incubation Program, You ThinkGreen Egypt (for Larus Textile)	2019